

MANDATORY REPORTING TRAINING

Purpose: To equip Community Camp Leaders to recognize and appropriately respond when a student shares information indicating they are being harmed, may harm themselves, or may harm others — ensuring student safety, honoring trust, and following legal and ethical responsibilities.

WHEN MANDATORY REPORTING MAY BE NEEDED

Community Camp Leaders play a vital role in protecting students. You are required to report if a student shares information that falls under **The Three Hurts** — times when confidentiality cannot be maintained:

1. Someone is hurting or going to hurt a student

Examples include but are not limited to:

- Emotional, sexual, or physical abuse
- Neglect
- Bullying or threats
- Violence or danger from a peer or adult

2. A student is hurting or going to hurt themselves

Examples include but are not limited to:

- Self-harm or attempts
- Suicidal thoughts or intent
- Substance abuse use that endangers them

3. A student is hurting or going to hurt someone else

Examples include but are not limited to:

- Plans to harm another person
- Abuse or violence toward others
- Threats, bullying, or dangerous behavior

BEST PRACTICES FOR HANDLING THESE SITUATIONS

1. Stay Calm and Present

- Keep your tone steady and warm
- Your calm helps the student feel safe
- You don't need all the answers — just be present

2. Be Honest About Confidentiality

- Say before opening group or one-on-one time:
 - "This is a safe space. Most of what you share stays between us. The only time I have to share information is if you tell me you're hurting yourself, hurting someone else, or someone else is hurting you — then I have to tell someone who can help keep you safe."
- Never promise secrecy.

3. Listen with Compassion

- Let them talk — don't rush
- Use empathy statements:
 - "That sounds really hard. I'm glad you told me."
- Validate their feelings without minimizing or fixing.

4. Ask Clarifying Safety Questions

These help leadership assess immediacy of risk:

- "Is this happening right now?"
- "When was the last time it happened?"
- "Does anyone else know?"

Do **not** investigate or push for details — just gather what keeps them safe.

5. Maintain Student Safety and Dignity

- Keep a gentle tone
- Avoid reacting with shock or judgment
- Stay with the student if they are in immediate danger

6. Communicate Immediately

Contact your **Tier #3 Community Youth Leadership** as soon as possible.

If harm is **immediate or active** (self-harm, abuse at camp, threat of violence):

- **Do not leave the student alone**
- Notify Tier #3 leaders immediately

If harm is **not immediate but real** (past abuse, ongoing home situation):

- Contact leadership **as soon as possible after the conversation**

7. Let Leadership Handle Next Steps

Once reported:

- Do not discuss the situation with other leaders or students
- Leadership will contact parents, authorities, and support services if needed

8. Follow Up with Care

- Continue showing support
- Let the student know they were right to tell someone
- Encourage ongoing openness and connection

QUICK “MANDATORY REPORTING DO’S AND DON’TS”

✓ Do

- Stay calm and caring
- Listen without judgment
- Be clear about safety boundaries
- Ask basic safety questions
- Report immediately to Tier #3 leadership
- Protect the student’s privacy **except** when safety is at risk

✗ Don’t

- Promise to keep secrets
- Investigate or ask leading questions
- Try to handle it alone
- Share the information with anyone except leadership
- Minimize or brush off concerns